

Race Timing App

Project Plan & Monetization Roadmap

Triathlon Race Management · Chiapas, Mexico

The Problem

Local triathlon events in Chiapas lack accurate timing and placement data. Race organizers rely on manual, error-prone methods. Athletes finish a race without knowing their official time or category placement. This gap represents a real, unmet need — and a business opportunity.

The Solution

A fully offline race timing web app (PWA) that works on any laptop or tablet with no internet required on race day. The organizer pre-loads athlete data beforehand; a volunteer logs bib numbers at the finish line in real time; results are shared with athletes after the event via email or WhatsApp.

How It Works — 3 Moments

Before the race Organizer imports athlete list: bib number, name, gender, age category, distance, email/phone.	Race day (offline) Volunteer types bib number as athletes cross the finish line. App auto-timestamps each entry and confirms athlete name. No internet needed.	After the race Once WiFi is available: send each athlete their time + category placement via email or WhatsApp. Export full PDF results table.
--	--	--

Results Table Structure

Results are automatically sorted and filterable by: overall placement · category · distance · gender.

Place	Bib	Name	Category	Distance	Time
1°	042	Carlos Ruiz	M 30–34	Sprint	1:12:44

2°	017	Ana Torres	F 25–29	Sprint	1:18:02
3°	091	Marcos León	M 40–44	Olympic	2:04:18
4°	058	Laura Pérez	F 35–39	Olympic	2:11:55

Development Roadmap

Phase 0

Validate before you build

Timeline: 1 month | Cost: \$0

- Run 1 real race using Google Sheets + a stopwatch
- Prove the timing process works manually
- Talk to 3–5 organizers — ask if they'd pay \$50–100/event
- If they say yes, you have a real business

Phase 1

MVP — no-code prototype

Timeline: 2–3 months | Cost: \$30–100/mo

- Build with Glide or Bubble (no coding required)
- Offline data storage using local browser tools
- Volunteer types bib → athlete auto-identified → time stamped
- Results table auto-sorts by category and distance
- Export to PDF · share via WhatsApp after event

Phase 2

Real product + first revenue

Timeline: 4–6 months | Cost: \$1,000–3,000 one-time dev

- Hire a freelance developer (React + Firebase or SQLite)
- Proper multi-race dashboard for organizers
- Athlete profiles with personal records history
- Charge organizers \$50–150 per event
- Target: 2–5 events/month = \$100–750 MRR

Phase 3

Scale + deeper monetization

Timeline: 12–18 months from start | Cost: \$2,000–5,000 MRR target

- Monthly subscription plans for organizers (\$30–80/mo)
- White-label option for triathlon clubs and federations
- Athlete premium tier: analytics, certificates, training insights
- Expand to other endurance sports: running, cycling, duathlon
- Expand across Mexico: Oaxaca, Veracruz, CDMX

Recommended Tech Stack

Layer	Tool	Why
App type	PWA (Progressive Web App)	Works offline · runs in any browser · no app store needed
Frontend	React.js	Beginner-friendly · huge community · lots of tutorials
Offline data	Dexie.js (IndexedDB)	Stores all athlete + race data locally on the device
Email send	EmailJS	Send results by email directly from the app, free tier
WhatsApp	WhatsApp Business API	Send individual result messages to athletes' phones
PDF export	jsPDF	Generate results sheets directly in the browser
Hosting	Netlify or Vercel	Free hosting · easy deploy · HTTPS included

Key Risks & Mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
No internet at venue	App is fully offline — this is already solved by design
Organizers won't pay	Offer first 2–3 events free, then charge once value is proven
Timing errors on race day	Add a correction mode so any logged time can be edited
Competitor apps (Webscorer, etc.)	Compete on price, local service, and Spanish-language support
Developer costs too high	Start with no-code (Phase 1) before hiring a dev

Your Next 3 Actions

1	Build the spreadsheet prototype	Create a fake race with 20 athletes in Google Sheets. Simulate the finish line logging. Generate a race report.
2	Approach 1 local race organizer	Offer to time their next event for free using your spreadsheet method. This validates demand before building the app.
3	Get a quote from a freelance developer	Post on Workana.com or Freelancer.mx with your spreadsheet spec. Budget \$500–1,500 USD for a simple app.